Office of Technology & Innovation

OFFICE OF TECHNOLOGY AND INNOVATION TESTIMONY BEFORE THE NEW YORK CITY COUNCIL COMMITTEE ON TECHNOLOGY

Oversight - New York City's 311 System.

Int 0173-2026: Use of global positioning system coordinates for 311 complaints and service requests.

Int 0669-2026 : Referring 311 non-emergency traffic condition complaints to the transportation bureau of the police department.

Int 0800-2026: Requiring the 311 customer service center to redirect requests for service or complaints to the appropriate agency.

September 30, 2026

Good afternoon, Chair De La Rosa, and members of the City Council Committee on Technology. My name is Joe Morrisroe, and I am the Deputy Commissioner of NYC311. Over the last 20 years, I have overseen NYC311's transformation from a call center to the multi-channel multi-language platform it is today. I'm pleased to join the Committee today to discuss our operations, highlight our recent successes, and discuss today's proposed legislation.

As you all know, NYC311 delivers fast and easy access to government services and information to all New Yorkers, with the highest possible level of customer service. NYC311 is available 24 hours a day, 7 days a week, 365 days a year through multiple channels, including the call center, online portal, text, mobile application, and social media. Originally launched as a call center, NYC311 has evolved into the most comprehensive municipal government customer service platform in the nation. NYC311 received 37 million customer contacts in 2025, and on an annual basis receives more calls than all other U.S. city 311 call centers combined.

I am also pleased to share with the Council a recent report by an independent third party on the public's satisfaction with NYC311. Call center representatives received a customer satisfaction rating of 93 percent, and 90 percent of respondents stated they are likely to recommend NYC311, outperforming best in class private sector companies. This level of public satisfaction is a testament to the dedication and commitment of the NYC311 team that serves their fellow New Yorkers every day.

It is important to note that NYC311 serves as the platform to provide information and services to the public. With few exceptions, public interactions with NYC311 result in one of the following outcomes:

1. The customer has an information request, such as garbage pickup day, and the information is provided;
2. A customer is referred to an external entity, including a utility or state or federal agency; or
3. A customer's inquiry is submitted as a Service Request (SR) to the designated agency and a confirmation tracking number is provided.

We rely on our collaborative relationships with each city agency to build out service request forms and information pages (also known as "knowledge articles") that properly reflect the mission and services for each agency or office. NYC311 does not create service requests unilaterally. There must be an agency that will accept the request, investigate, and if applicable, undertake appropriate action or resolution. Once a service request is submitted through NYC311, it becomes the responding agency's responsibility to address and respond.

When an agency decides that amending a current service request or adding a new one is necessary, it contacts NYC311 to create, test and deploy a service request form. Agency feedback partially informs the updates we implement to the entire NYC311 platform. User feedback is also extremely useful to us, which is why we deploy customer surveys that inform the Resolution Satisfaction (RSAT) Dashboard, which is available on the City's website. We also value the input we receive from Council Members as frequent NYC311 users, and I'm happy to continue the conversation.

I will now turn to the legislation associated with this hearing.

Introduction 173-2026 would require the use of global positioning system (GPS) coordinates for 311 service requests. We agree that our user interface would be improved with the capability to capture a user's coordinates with a familiar "pin drop" that many other location-based applications use. Currently, NYC311 service requests collect GPS coordinates (latitude/longitude) based on the customer enabling location services in the mobile app or on the website, and by the customer confirming the address identified. If location services functionality is disabled, NYC311 collects latitude and longitude based on the address entered by the customer. We have been exploring how our geolocator (ESRI) service could collect latitude and longitude based on a pin drop, then identify the address in the format required by the agency based on the service request (address, intersection, or block face). I am looking forward to working with Council to find the best path forward for this enhancement.

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Introduction 669-2026 proposes to refer 311 non-emergency traffic condition complaints to the transportation bureau of the police department. As I noted above, we work with each agency to develop service requests to work best for the customer and agency policies and workflows that support their responsibilities. For the types of complaints listed in this legislation, the protocol is similar: if a customer describes an emergency condition in progress, the call is transferred to 911. A call describing a non-emergency situation will generate a service request that is routed to the appropriate NYPD precinct. NYPD has determined that this is the course of action to occur for such complaints. While the NYC311 system is capable of changing the way such complaints are routed, neither OTI nor NYC311 can comment on the merits of the proposal, as the underlying policy and procedures belong to NYPD. The NYPD has told us that they believe many of the calls contemplated by the bill should be routed through 911, and that many would call for responses from other Bureaus within the department. I urge the Council to discuss this proposal directly with NYPD, who would be happy to meet with the sponsors.

Finally, Int 800-2026 would require NYC 311 to redirect service requests to the appropriate agency. While a vast majority of service requests are appropriately assigned and routed to agencies, there are some exceptions that it appears this legislation is seeking to address. A common example is when a customer reports a street cave-in. The Department of Transportation (DOT) initially investigates reports of cave-ins, determines who is responsible for restoring the roadway, and then refers the cave-in to that agency or utility for repair. Information about the agency or utility responsible for repairing the cave-in will be available within 10 days of submitting a service request. That said, I understand the customer's frustration when this occurs, which is why we have been identifying solutions for these kinds of scenarios. I am happy to talk you through how we have been thinking about implementing solutions to this problem and align on best next steps to make this process better for New Yorkers.

Thank you once again for the opportunity to testify today. I will now take Council Members' questions.

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JUMAANE D. WILLIAMS

STATEMENT OF PUBLIC ADVOCATE JUMAANE D. WILLIAMS
TO THE NEW YORK CITY COUNCIL COMMITTEE ON TECHNOLOGY
SEPTEMBER 30, 2026

Good morning,

My name is Jumaane D. Williams and I am the Public Advocate for the City of New York. I want to thank Chair de la Rosa and the members of the Committee on Technology for holding this hearing today.

NYC 311 is a critical resource that gives New Yorkers a centralized way to report issues and connect with the appropriate City agencies for matters that range from the most mundane to the most technical. All City agencies require a 311 reference number to initiate an investigation into any complaint. However, from the perspective of my office's Constituent Services, 311 also gives us a starting point for case management. A service request number allows our team to research the history of an issue, identify what action has been taken, and determine where additional follow-up may be needed. It also helps us recognize recurring issues and trends affecting New Yorkers, dictating our unit's outreach and agency engagement.

One of the busiest seasons for 311 and our Constituent Services team begins tomorrow: heat season. With a rise in devastating fires, especially in the Bronx, preparing for heat season requires dedicated outreach and awareness campaigns, adequate staffing and resources for our Fire Department and call centers, as well as the Department of Housing Preservation and Development. Last year, during a brutally cold winter, record numbers of New Yorkers called 311 (approximately 30,000 complaints) yet 58% of those calls were flagged as duplicates and the tickets closed without investigation.[1] This is simply unacceptable and while we are heartened by the news from the Mayor that every heat complaint will now be investigated, this work cannot be done without adequate staffing and resources.[2] I look forward to working with the Administration to ensure this heat season is the safest on record. Thank you.

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[1] Spauster, Patrick. "How NYC Closed Tens of Thousands of 'No Heat' Complaints Without Conducting an Inspection". *City Limits*. (April 2026)
[2] Gonella, Catalina. "Mamdani says NYC will investigate every tenant heat complaint starting this October." *Gothamist*. (September 2026)

EXECUTIVE BRIEFING SHEET

TO: Members & Staff, Committee on Technology

FROM: Chowdhury Hasan Mahmud, PMP, CISA, CISM, CCSP **DATE:** September 30, 2026

SUBJECT: Policy Recommendation: Pre- and Post-Investment Audit Framework for Public Safety Technology

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

As New York City accelerates its investment in critical public safety technology—including emergency dispatch, 911 call routing, and SIEM/SOC analytics—ensuring system reliability, cybersecurity, and vendor accountability is paramount. Recent operational disruptions underscore the risk of tech deployments that lack independent oversight.

To safeguard emergency response times and municipal funds, the City Council should mandate an independent **Pre- and Post-Investment Public Safety Audit Framework** for all major IT acquisitions within emergency response agencies.

KEY POLICY RECOMMENDATIONS

1. Pre-Investment Oversight (Ex-Ante Audits)

- **Technical Risk & Security Architecture:** Mandate independent reviews of cybersecurity compliance (CCSP/CISM standards), data protection, and legacy system interoperability prior to contract execution.
- **Civil Service & Operational Alignment:** Ensure technology acquisitions support and empower permanent civil service workflows rather than creating long-term dependencies on unvetted external contractors.
- **Defined Target Metrics:** Require quantifiable baseline metrics (e.g., dispatch latency thresholds, target mean-time-to-detect security threats, uptime requirements) before capital allocation.

2. Post-Investment Performance Reviews (Ex-Post Audits)

- **Contractual & Deliverable Verification:** Require formal post-deployment audits to confirm that vendor deliverables match contract specifications and that paid-for features are fully functional.
- **Performance vs. Baseline Measurement:** Evaluate actual operational outcomes against pre-established baselines to measure true system efficacy and response readiness.

- **Resilience & Disaster Recovery Testing:** Conduct recurring audits of disaster recovery capabilities, software patch protocols, and system redundancy to prevent single points of failure in emergency dispatch.

COMMITTEE-SPECIFIC IMPACT

Committee	Strategic Oversight Focus
Technology	• Prevents sole-source vendor lock-in and scope creep. • Enforces strict PASSPort vendor evaluation criteria. • Ensures compliance with City cybersecurity standards.
Fire & Emergency Management	• Protects front-line dispatch operations (FireCAD / EMSCAD). • Mitigates unannounced software update disruptions. • Enhances situational awareness and field response readiness.

CONTACT INFORMATION

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- **Role:** Civil Servant & IT Quality Assurance Auditor

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Appearance Card

I intend to appear and speak on Int. No. _____ Res. No. _____

☐ in favor ☐ in opposition

Date: 9/30/26

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Name: Joe Morrisroe

Address: _____

I represent: Office of Technology & Innovation

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